Bylaws of Wild Goose Lake Protection Association, Inc.

A Michigan nonprofit corporation Proposed for adoption by the members on November 14, 2026

Article I — Name and Purpose

1. The name of the corporation is Wild Goose Lake Protection Association, Inc. (the "Association"), a Michigan nonprofit corporation organized on a membership basis.
2. The Association is organized and operated exclusively for charitable, educational, and scientific purposes within the meaning of Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code: to protect and restore the water quality, natural habitat, and ecological health of Wild Goose Lake in Lyndon Township, Washtenaw County, Michigan; to educate the public about inland lake stewardship; to preserve and share the history of the Wild Goose Lake community; to keep the cost of a public lake-improvement program within reach of every household on the lake through the Lake Program Fund; and to relieve financial hardship among lake property owners through the Neighbor Fund, all as stated in its Articles of Incorporation.
3. No part of the Association's net earnings may benefit any director, officer, member, or private person. The Association will not participate or intervene in any campaign for or against any candidate for public office, and no substantial part of its activities will consist of attempting to influence legislation. The Association will not carry on any activity not permitted to an organization exempt under Section 501(c)(3) or to one whose contributions are deductible under Section 170(c)(2).
4. The Association's work with the State of Michigan, Washtenaw County and/or Lyndon Township on a lake improvement project is the provision of information and technical cooperation on a matter of public health and the environment, not campaign activity.

Article II — Members

1. Every owner of record of a lakefront property, or of a property with deeded or platted access to Wild Goose Lake, is eligible to be a member of the Association. Membership is conferred upon payment of dues.
2. Each property has one vote. Contiguous parcels under one ownership with no more than one dwelling count as one property (a "Property"). Owners of more than one Property have one vote per Property. Co-owners decide among themselves who casts the vote. Where Washtenaw County has confirmed a special assessment roll for the lake, the Properties on that roll are the Properties for purposes of these bylaws.

3. The State of Michigan, Detroit Public Schools Community District, Lyndon Township, Washtenaw County, and any other public body that owns property on the lake are not eligible for membership, but shall receive every notice under Article VII as a courtesy and may attend and speak at meetings.
4. **Dues and gifts.** Annual membership dues are $10 a year for each member household. The Association uses dues to support its operations: the newsletter, the website, insurance, lake-related events and projects, and a savings reserve for unusual and unexpected costs. In addition, dues may be applied to the engagement of qualified professional advisors and consultants, including but not limited to, attorneys, accountants, auditors, limnologists, aquatic biologists, environmental engineers, grant writers, and other professionals in lake management or nonprofit governance, to render advice and services to the Association in furtherance of its exempt purposes.
5. Any other person who supports the purposes of the Association, including former residents and descendants of Wild Goose Lake families, may be an associate member on request. Associate members may attend meetings, serve on committees, and give, but do not vote.

Article III — Meetings of Members

1. The annual meeting is held each September on a date, time, and place set by the Board. Business includes the Treasurer's report, the lake report, election of the Board, and the suggested annual gift for the coming year, and any other business.
2. Special meetings may be called by the President, by a majority of the Board, or by written request of ten members.
3. Notice of every meeting, stating the date, time, place, and business to be conducted, is given at least fourteen days before the meeting in the manner set out in Article VII. Any member may attend and vote by video or telephone if the notice says how.
4. Members present at a properly noticed meeting constitute a quorum. Questions are decided by a majority of the votes cast unless these bylaws say otherwise.
5. Votes may be taken by voice, by show of hands, or by written ballot at the request of any member.
6. Any vote the members may take at a meeting, including the election of directors, may instead be taken by ballot delivered to every member in the manner set out in Article VII, with at least fourteen days to return it online or on paper.

Article IV — Board of Directors

1. The Association is managed by a Board of Directors consisting of the four officers and one at large director. All are members of the Association and serve without pay.
2. The officers are the President, Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer.

- The **President** presides at meetings, is the Association's single point of contact with Washtenaw County, Lyndon Township, and the lake-management contractors, and signs documents the Board approves.
- The **Vice President** acts for the President when the President is absent.
- The **Secretary** keeps the minutes and the member contact list (name, property, email address, and mailing address for those without email), gives meeting notices, and posts notices, minutes, and documents on the Association website as Article VII requires.
- The **Treasurer** receives dues, gifts and issues acknowledgments, pays approved bills, keeps the books, files the annual report with the State of Michigan, and presents a written financial report at the annual meeting and at any meeting on request.

3. Directors are elected by the members at the annual meeting for one-year terms and serve until their successors are elected. Nominations are taken from the floor. Any member may be nominated.
4. A vacancy between annual meetings is filled by the Board until the next annual meeting.
5. The Board meets at least twice a year, at the call of the President. A majority of directors is a quorum. Members may attend Board meetings.

Article V — Finances

1. The fiscal year is January 1 through December 31.
2. Checks or payments over $500 require two signatures or two approvals.
3. The Association maintains membership in the Michigan Lakes and Streams Association and such other organizations as the Board approves.
4. The Treasurer's annual report, once approved by the members, is posted on the Association website.
5. The Treasurer files the annual IRS information return (Form 990-N or 990-EZ), the Michigan nonprofit annual report, and any charitable-solicitation registration the Michigan Attorney General requires, and gives donors written acknowledgment of every gift of $250 or more.
6. The Association may accept grants from foundations and government agencies and gifts from any person for its exempt purposes. The Board may decline any gift.

Article VI — Committees

1. **Weed Control Committee.** Surveys the lake each spring and fall, meets with Washtenaw County's lake-management staff and the County's lake scientist, reports conditions and recommendations to the Board and the members, and keeps the history of weed control on the website.

2. **Water Quality Monitoring.** Takes water clarity, temperature, dissolved oxygen, and phosphorus readings through the Cooperative Lakes Monitoring Program and reports results at the annual meeting.
3. **Website and Newsletter.** Maintains the Association website and publishes a newsletter to members at least twice a year.
4. **Events.** Organizes the annual meeting, the summer gathering, and such community events as the members choose.
5. **Giving and Grants.** Raises funds through the annual gift, grants, business sponsors, and descendants of Wild Goose Lake families.
6. The Board may create other committees as needed. Committee chairs are elected at the annual meeting with the officers.

Article VII — Notices and Communications

1. **The website is the Association's official record.** Every meeting notice, agenda, ballot, proposed bylaw amendment, cost estimate, Neighbor Fund announcement, set of minutes, financial report, and lake report is posted on the Association website at wildgooselake.org. Posting is the Association's primary means of publication, and members are expected to look there.
2. **How notice is given.** Because Michigan law requires that notice of a members' meeting or ballot be delivered to each voting member personally, by mail, or by electronic transmission the member has authorized, the Secretary gives notice as follows:
    - **By email** to every member who has given the Association an email address. By giving an email address, a member authorizes the Association to send all notices, ballots, and documents to that address, and agrees that an email saying a document has been posted on the website, with a link to it, is delivery of the document.
    - **By text message** instead of or in addition to email, for any member who asks for it in writing.
    - **By first-class mail** only to members who have not given an email address, or who ask in writing to receive paper. The mailing may be a one-page notice that says what has been posted on the website and where, and how to get a paper copy on request.
3. **No email, no paper?** If a member has given no email address and no mailing address other than the lake property, notice to the lake property address is sufficient.
4. **Non-member owners.** Where these bylaws require that something go to every owner of lakefront and lake-access property, whether or not a member, the Secretary uses the same methods, using the owner's address on the Washtenaw County tax roll where no other address is known.

5. **Timing.** Notice is given when the email or text is sent, when the paper notice is deposited in the mail, or when the Association posts a required item on the website and has already sent members the standing website address, whichever is earliest and permitted for that notice by law.
6. **Contact information.** The Secretary keeps the contact list and runs this process:
    - **How a member gives an email address.** Any of the following counts as giving the Association an email address and authorizing electronic notice to it: emailing the Secretary at secretary.pa@wildgooselake.org from that address with the member's name and lake property; checking the notices box on the contact form at wildgooselake.org; writing it on an annual giving notice or reply card, a Neighbor Fund form, a ballot, or a meeting sign-in sheet; or giving it to any director in writing. The Secretary sends a confirmation email within fourteen days, and the address is in effect when the confirmation is sent.
    - **What is recorded.** For each member: name, lake property and parcel number, email address, mailing address if different from the lake property, the date and source of the email authorization, and, for each notice sent, the date and method. For owners without email, the mailing address from the Washtenaw County tax roll.
    - **Changes and paper requests.** A member may change an email address, add a text number, or ask for paper notices by writing to the Secretary at the address above or at the Association's mailing address. The change takes effect for the next notice sent after the Secretary records it.
    - **Bounced email.** If notice to a member's email address is returned undelivered twice in a row, the Secretary sends that member's notices by first-class mail until the member supplies a working address, and tries to reach the member by phone if a number is on file.
    - **Annual check.** Each year's annual giving notice and the annual meeting sign-in sheet show the member's email address on file and ask the member to confirm or correct it.
    - **Privacy.** The contact list is used only for Association business, is never sold, shared, or published, and is available to directors and committee chairs only to the extent needed for their duties. A member may ask that their email address not be shared with other members, and the Association never sends group email with members' addresses visible.
    - **Each member's duty.** Each member is responsible for giving the Secretary a working email address and reporting changes. A member who has given an email address and has not reported a change cannot object to notice sent to that address.
7. **Remote meetings.** The Board may hold any meeting of members or directors in person, by video or telephone, or both, and the notice says which.

Article VIII — Amendments

Amendments to these bylaws may be proposed by any member at the annual meeting or in writing to the Board. The Board reviews proposals and presents them, with its recommendation, to the members at the next annual or special meeting or by ballot under Article III.6, where they are adopted by a majority of the votes cast, provided the proposed text was posted on the website and included in the notice.

Article IX — Dissolution

If the Association dissolves, any remaining assets, after paying the Association's debts, shall be distributed to one or more organizations then exempt under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, or to the State of Michigan, Washtenaw County, or Lyndon Township for a public purpose, in each case for the protection of Wild Goose Lake or Michigan inland lakes, as the members decide. No assets go to any director, officer, member, or private person.

Article X — Adoption and Transition

1. These bylaws take effect when adopted by the majority vote of member eligible property owners at a meeting noticed to every owner of lakefront and lake-access property.
2. At the same meeting the members elect the first Board of Directors under Article IV. The first directors serve until the first annual meeting in September 2027, when directors are elected for one-year terms as Article IV provides.
3. Until the first Board is elected, the incorporator and the organizing committee may act for the Association only to call and give notice of the adoption meeting, open the bank accounts, make the state and federal filings described in Articles I and V, answer requests for information from Washtenaw County and Lyndon Township.

Adopted by the members at a meeting held on _____, 20____.

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Secretary